continuously review and renew ourselves if we have to compete with the best in the world.

In the coming year, much will be demanded of reporting officers. They need to let their subordinates know, perhaps even as frequently as every quarter, how their performance has been, and even informally document this discussion. The final performance appraisal should differentiate good from bad performance, and should not come as a surprise to the person being evaluated – they should have picked up cues during the year. Subordinates who are not getting regular feedback should ask their reporting officers. This means more work for all, but it will be critical in helping us improve.

Let me highlight an issue that especially concerns me. As I sit through promotion interviews, I am worried that people are losing curiosity, the desire to learn and improve themselves. I am concerned that some people do not read outside the papers that come across their desk, that they have no idea of other branches of the Bank and their work, let alone the wider world. We emphasize specialization, but that does not mean there is no need to read the newspapers, let alone magazines and books. This has to change if the organization is to remain vibrant. In complacency and self-satisfaction lies a slow descent into mediocrity.

We do want to revamp the support we give our staff to learn. We intend to invest in our staff on a continuing basis, as evidenced by the expansion in Golden Jubilee fellowships. The coming year will be focused on revamping the Human Resource Department's efforts to assess individual needs and career plans and provide the necessary skill building. We want more of one's career in the Bank to be self-driven rather than driven by the needs of the Bank – though a mix of the two will always be inevitable, it is best when the two coincide.